whether I should buy this company's shares at the prevailing market. After considerable deliberation, I decided to go ahead.

I was right in diagnosing the potential of this company for it did grow in the years that followed. Nevertheless, it was a poor investment. My mistake lay in the price I paid to participate in the promise. Some years later, after the company had shown rather respectable growth, I sold these shares, but at a price very little different from my original cost. While I believe I was right in selling when I thought the company had reached a point where its future growth was considerably more uncertain, nevertheless selling an investment at a meager profit after it has been held for a number of years is not the way to make capital grow or even protect it against inflation. In this case, disappointing performance was the result of being seduced by the excitement of the times into paying an unrealistic initiation price.